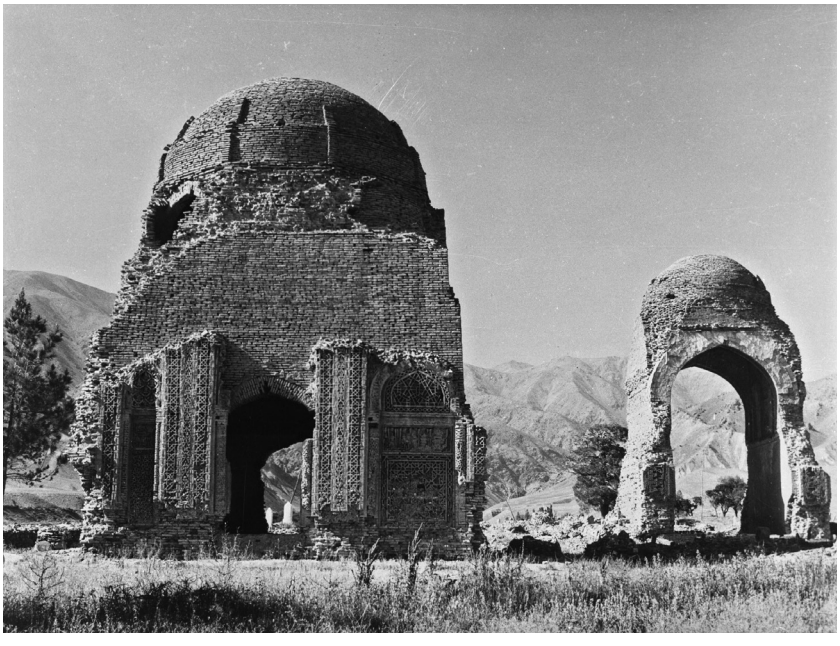


Figure 4.12 *Chisht, mausoleums (or* madrasa*/mosque complex), ruins: Mausoleum A, exterior, southern façade. © Photograph Josephine Powell* c. *1960. Harvard Fine Arts Library, Special Collections.*

Kufic inscription (Figure 4.15) furnishes the date of AH 562/1167 CE in Persian.[71] Chisht's less preserved, northeastern structure (Figure 4.12 [right structure]) also has an Arabic inscription with Ghiyath al-Din's correct titles, but in foliated Kufic and, notably, as they eventually appeared at the imposing *jami* of Herat at the end of the twelfth century.[72]

By considering the southwestern domed structure's *naskh* and Kufic inscriptions together, the seemingly egregious anachronism of the sultan's pre-regnal *laqab* of Shams al-Dunya wa al-Din – applicable only prior to AH 558/1163 CE – in the cursive text may present us with a chronological clue, not only for the structure but also the overall complex. It is worth considering that the southwestern structure was completed before the northeastern one, and *prior* to AH 558/1163 CE, or at least before wide circulation of the sultan's regnal *laqab* of Ghiyath al-Din.[73] The contents of the southwestern structure's *naskh* inscription, then, would also have been composed at this earlier date, thus still using the sultan's earlier name. The separate Kufic inscription in the same structure, however, lists the date of AH 10 Jumada I 562/4 March 1167 CE, but only after a long series of Qur'anic verses rather than the description of an event. Given that the cursive and Kufic inscriptions are separate, it is possible that the latter does not refer to the above-mentioned renovation (*tajdid*), but rather to some other, as yet not fully known, intervention in the structure or complex as a whole.